Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-17

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 27:1-24

1 And the children of Israel, according to their number, the heads of fathers' houses, the captains of thousands and hundreds and their officers, served the king in every matter of the military divisions. These divisions came in and went out month by month throughout all the months of the year, each division having twenty-four thousand.

2 Over the first division for the first month was Jashobeam the son of Zabdiel, and in his division were twenty-four thousand;

3 he was of the children of Perez, and the chief of all the captains of the army for the first month.

4 Over the division of the second month was Dodai an Ahohite, and of his division Mikloth also was the leader; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

5 The third captain of the army for the third month was Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada the priest, who was chief; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

6 This was the Benaiah who was mighty among the thirty, and was over the thirty; in his division was Ammizabad his son.

7 The fourth captain for the fourth month was Asahel the brother of Joab, and Zebadiah his son after him; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

8 The fifth captain for the fifth month was Shamhuth the Izrahite; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

9 The sixth captain for the sixth month was Ira the son of Ikkesh the Tekoite; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

10 The seventh captain for the seventh month was Helez the Pelonite, of the children of Ephraim; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

11 The eighth captain for the eighth month was Sibbechai the Hushathite, of the Zarhites; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

12 The ninth captain for the ninth month was Abiezer the Anathothite, of the Benjamites; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

13 The tenth captain for the tenth month was Maharai the Netophathite, of the Zarhites; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

14 The eleventh captain for the eleventh month was Benaiah the Pirathonite, of the children of Ephraim; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

15 The twelfth captain for the twelfth month was Heldai the Netophathite, of Othniel; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

16 Furthermore, over the tribes of Israel: the officer over the Reubenites was Eliezer the son of Zichri; over the Simeonites, Shephatiah the son of Maachah;

17 over the Levites, Hashabiah the son of Kemuel; over the Aaronites, Zadok;

18 over Judah, Elihu, one of David’ s brothers; over Issachar, Omri the son of Michael;

19 over Zebulun, Ishmaiah the son of Obadiah; over Naphtali, Jerimoth the son of Azriel;

20 over the children of Ephraim, Hoshea the son of Azaziah; over the half-tribe of Manasseh, Joel the son of Pedaiah;

21 over the half-tribe of Manasseh in Gilead, Iddo the son of Zechariah; over Benjamin, Jaasiel the son of Abner;

22 over Dan, Azarel the son of Jeroham. These were the leaders of the tribes of Israel.

23 But David did not take the number of those twenty years old and under, because the Lord had said He would multiply Israel like the stars of the heavens.

24 Joab the son of Zeruiah began a census, but he did not finish, for wrath came upon Israel because of this census; nor was the number recorded in the account of the chronicles of King David.

II. Key Summary

• The heads of fathers' houses, the captains of thousands and hundreds, and their officers served the king in twelve divisions of twenty-four thousand each, coming in and going out month by month; every month from the first to the twelfth had its own captain, such as Benaiah, who was mighty among the thirty, and Asahel, whose son Zebadiah

came after him.

- Verses 16–22 list the leaders over the tribes of Israel, such as Elihu, one of David's brothers, over Judah; Zadok over the Aaronites; and Jaasiel the son of Abner over Benjamin.
- David did not take the number of those twenty years old and under, because the Lord had said He would multiply Israel like the stars of the heavens; Joab began a census but did not finish, for wrath came upon Israel, and the number was not recorded in the chronicles of King David.

III. Passage Analysis

What the Father Didn't Finish, the Son Carried On

> He took up his father's work: although his father never saw David's unified kingdom with his own eyes, he himself did his part for the unification of the kingdom of Israel. [1]

Verse 7 names the captain of the fourth month as "Asahel the brother of Joab," and adds "and Zebadiah his son after him." Asahel was struck down by Abner in 2 Samuel 2:23, before David was anointed king over Israel (2 Sam. 5:3).

The day Asahel never saw, his son stood in the captain's place.

Abner's Son Among the Leaders

> Though Abner was David's enemy, and opposed his coming to the throne, yet David would not oppose the preferment of his son, but perhaps nominated him to this post of honour, which teaches us to render good for evil. [2]

Abner sided with the house of Saul in its war with the house of David (2 Sam. 3:6), and only later made a covenant with David (2 Sam. 3:12–13).

The son of a man who once stood on the other side is listed among "the leaders of the tribes of Israel" (vv. 21–22).

IV. Reflection Question

If you were the one handing out jobs, and one of the people had once been on the opposite side from you, how would you place him?

Abner had fought for the house of Saul against the house of David (2 Sam. 3:6); in this list, his son Jaasiel stands among the leaders of the tribes of Israel (vv. 21–22).

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), "Gleanings on 1 Chronicles 27" (Bible Intensive Study Edition), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%201Chro/13GT27.htm

[2] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry's Commentary (1 Chronicles 27), https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/1Ch/1Ch_027.cfm